

The Book of Words

Everything the Way of Mercury says



The Door, the Dedication, the two Invocations, the Clearing, seventeen callings, the sayings, ten convening prayers, nine prayers of the Work, four blessings, and the short forms. Say them, aloud or within. Change the wording until each line sounds like you and you mean it.

HOW THIS IS USED

The Book of the Temple holds the rites and the reasons; this holds the words. Everything the Temple says is here, so that one small book is all you need at the Door. Nothing here is required, and nothing replaces the Door. Say it aloud, or read it slowly within, every word and none skimmed; said within, it stays private, even in a café or on a train. A spell skimmed is a paragraph. Change the wording until each line sounds like you and you mean it.

WHAT IS HERE, AND WHEN

THE DOOR. The Short Door for every session; the full Opening and Closing whenever you want more.

THE DEDICATION. Written once, on the first page of a Book.

THE TWO INVOCATIONS, AND THE CLEARING. Descend to bind; ascend to ask, to give, and to release; clear what is not yours.

THE CALLINGS. Seventeen: one for the Heart, one for the Hinge, one for each of the eight pairs, one for each of the six triads, and the Calling of the Company. A calling names who you want, makes a small offering with the hands, and says what they are called to. Said on the days each one names, or whenever that work is at hand.

THE SAYINGS. One line for each of the seventeen seats, and two for the Moon. Enough for a thin day.

THE CONVENING PRAYERS. Ten, one for each committee, said when you need that body, before the work it is for.

THE PRAYERS OF THE WORK. Nine, for protection, the scale, what you fear, favor, passing unnoticed, the home, sanctuary, the one who can help, and abundance and luck. Each comes with its earthly part: the prayer stands beside the deed, never instead of it.

THE BLESSINGS. Four, said over someone else.

THE SHORT FORMS. The single lines said inside the rites, gathered so they can be found.

THE DAYS AND WHAT THEY ASK

Every day of the Calendar asks a certain amount, and no more.

THE HEART DAYS ask the most: the High Heart and the Deep Heart, Mercury's two meetings with the Sun. The full Door, the Calling of the Heart, and the working that matters most.

THE WHEEL DAYS are the fourteen days of the year's wheel. Each asks its Act, its Page, and its Giving, and the calling of whoever keeps the day.

THE MOVING DAYS are the Scribe's own: the Good Hour, declared when it comes; the Book's Day; and your birthday. Each is kept as the Calendar describes.

THE RECURRING DAYS are Wednesday, the first with its Sweep, the fourth, the seventh, and Gabriel's two moons, with the Deipnon and the Noumenia on either side of the New Moon for those who keep them. A saying is enough.

The Fallow Month asks nothing.

THE SHORT DOOR

For every session. Written at the top of the inside front and back covers.

OPENING

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices, co-conspirators
in the Work:

I bring you my whole self: my Voice, and my Joy, Will, and Intent.

Deed into word. By my Birthright, the Door is open.

CLOSING

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices:

I leave here my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and Intent into the
world.

Word into deed. By my Birthright, the Door is closed.

A short Door honestly spoken is better than a long one skipped.

THE FULL OPENING

Written inside the front cover, beneath the Short Door.

Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, AONT and the four: I bring to you my Presence, and take up the seat as Idris did before me: student, teacher, and sage. Let your Light shine so that I may see.

Janus and Hestia, the Door and the Flame: I bring to you my Time.

Metatron and Sandalphon, Holder of the Seat and Carrier of the Ascent: I bring to you my Hands.

Uriel and Raziel, Instructor and Translator, Guardians of Daath: I bring to you my Ears.

Gabriel and Idris, Holder of Images and Scribe of the Seat: I bring to you my Eyes.

Seshat and Iris, Founder and Oath-bearer, who keep the Word given: I bring to you my Word.

Rosmerta and the Charites, the Given and the Passed On: I bring to you my Delight.

Hermanubis and Ma'at, Guide of the Descent and Feather of Truth, who keep the Scale: I bring to you my Heart.

Thermes and Apharael, the Word that Makes and the Word that is True: I bring to you my Mind.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: I bring to you my Weight.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great, the Crossing, the Guide of the Descent, and the Hinge on which the Door turns: I bring to you my Voice and my Devotion.

Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: I bring to you my Mercurial Joy, Will, and Intent.

By my Birthright, I open the Door of this Book, a Window into your Temple, the threshold through which you guide me.

Deed into word.

The Door is open.

THE FULL CLOSING

Written inside the back cover, beneath the Short Door.

Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, AONT and the four: I thank you for what was given and what was found. I set down the pen as Idris did before me, and carry what I have learned so that I may teach it. Let your Light go with me.

Janus and Hestia, the Door and the Flame: I thank you for keeping my Time.

Metatron and Sandalphon, Holder of the Seat and Carrier of the Ascent: I thank you for guiding my Hands.

Uriel and Raziel, Instructor and Translator, Guardians of Daath: I thank you for opening my Ears.

Gabriel and Idris, Holder of Images and Scribe of the Seat: I thank you for clearing my Eyes.

Seshat and Iris, Founder and Oath-bearer: I thank you for keeping and carrying my Word.

Rosmerta and the Charites, the Given and the Passed On: I thank you for my Delight, and for the hours I stayed inside.

Hermanubis and Ma'at, Guide of the Descent and Feather of Truth: I thank you for keeping my Heart light.

Thermes and Apharael, the Word that Makes and the Word that is True: I thank you for my Mind.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: I thank you for weighing my Weight truly.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great, the Crossing, the Guide of the Descent, and the Hinge on which the Door turns: I thank you for carrying my Voice, and for bringing me back across every crossing.

Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: I leave here my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and Intent out into the world.

By my Birthright, I close this Book and cross back over the threshold.

Word into deed.

The Door is closed.

THE DEDICATION

Written once, on the first page of the Book you dedicate, any day in your first month or on a Heart Day. Say it as you write it, aloud or within.

AONT, EHNB, XCAI, RMTO, PAAM, Quintessence, Heart of the Temple of Mercury: By my Birthright, I open this Book as a Window into your Temple, a room built beside its Heart. Shine through these pages.

Janus and Hestia, Metatron and Sandalphon, Uriel and Raziel, Gabriel and Idris, Seshat and Iris, Rosmerta and the Charites, Hermanubis and Ma'at, Thermes and Apharael: be welcome in your Offices in the pages of this Book.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: weigh what I write here.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great: I build this room in your Temple as a co-conspirator in our Great Work.

Mercury, host of this house, my twin and guide: meet me at the Door.

Idris, who held the pen before me: I take up the seat in your tradition.

Genius of this place: grow here, and keep this room with me.

Here I will tell the truth. Honesty is my offering; Joy is my Truth.

Together, let us make the unseen legible and the hidden speakable, carry what we find across every threshold, and give it freely, that word become deed and the Joy of Truth multiply in the world.

So it is written.

THE TWO INVOCATIONS

After Walking the Pillar. Descend to bind; ascend to ask, to give, and to release.

THE DESCENDING INVOCATION

word into world

Mercury, turn the Hinge.
Metatron, record this word.
Uriel and Raziel, weigh it and carry it to the Heart.
Apharael, show me the road.
Gabriel, hold its image until it takes form.
Sandalphon, carry it into the living world.
By my Birthright,
so it is written, and so it is.

THE ASCENDING INVOCATION

world into word

Mercury, turn the Hinge.
Sandalphon, gather this word.
Gabriel, take its image.
Apharael, carry it home.
Uriel and Raziel, weigh it and open the Gate.
Metatron, receive it into the record,
and let it rest in the Heart.
By my Birthright,
so it is given, and so it is.

THE CLEARING

*Hestia, Uriel, and Janus at the door. Done wholly in the mind, in a few breaths,
anywhere; the hands may join when there is time. For a room, or for yourself.*

THE CENTER

See a steady flame at the heart, or at the center of the room.

Hestia, keep the center.

NAME WHAT GOES

*The thing itself, or simply:
whatever is not mine.*

THE SWORD

Uriel's sword, from crown to feet, or around the walls.

Uriel, divide what is mine from what is not.

What is not mine goes.

THE DOOR

A door opens; breathe out, and see it cross and the door close.

Janus, show it out.

SEAL

Return to the flame.

The fire is kept.

What is finished has left by the door;
what is mine stays.

The short form: the flame, the sword, the door.

1. THE HEART

The offering is the Presence.

On the Heart Days, at the Dedication, and on the Book's Day.

The act. Put a hand flat on the open page, and be still for one breath before you begin.

AONT, EHNB, XCAI, RMTO, PAAM:

Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, I call you by your names.

AONT, the still point, who shows the whole at once.

EHNB, who untangles. XCAI, who gives the feeling its words.

RMTO, who lays the pattern. PAAM, who declares it.

By my Birthright I bring my Presence, which is all I have that is not words.

Shine on this page, and on [the work].

Let your light shine, that I may see.

2. MERCURY, THE HINGE

The offering is the Voice and the Devotion.

On Wednesdays, on the fourth of the month, and at any crossing.

The act. Say it, aloud or within, and set a coin on the threshold or on the open Book.

Mercury, Hinge of the Door, quick one, my twin:
god of the road and the word, the wage and the found coin,
who goes down and comes back up, and is found by the one who moves.
I bring my Voice and my Devotion.
Turn the Hinge for [the work].

Passage, luck, and return.

3. JANUS AND HESTIA

The offering is the Time.

On the first of the month, at the Door of the Year, and on moving day.

The act. *Touch the doorframe, then light a candle at the center of the room.*

Janus of the two faces, who sees what I leave and what I enter;

Hestia of the kept fire, who does not move:

he opens what she holds, and she holds what he opens.

I bring my Time.

Open and close these hours with me, and keep the hearth of [the work].

Give me clean crossings, and a fire I will find lit.

4. METATRON AND SANDALPHON

The offering is the Hands.

At the Casting, at the Ascent, and on your birthday.

The act. *Lay the pen across the open page, then set both feet flat on the floor.*

Metatron, Holder of the Seat, who was a man and sits because he writes;
Sandalphon, Carrier of the Ascent, who stands on the ground with his head in
heaven:

the one who records it and the one who builds it.

I bring my Hands.

Record what I write here, and carry it into the world as [the work].

Let what I write be true, and let what is true be done.

5. URIEL AND RAZIEL, THE GATE

—◆—
*The offering is the Ears.
Before any decision, and at both solstices.*

The act. Touch your throat, where the Gate stands, then lay a finger across your lip.

Uriel, light of God, whose sword cuts true from false and ready from unready;
Raziel, secret of God, who hears behind the curtain and keeps what is not yet
bearable:

one office, two faces, never fused.

I bring my Ears.

Weigh [the matter], and tell me which of you is speaking.

—◆—
Let me know what is true, what is mine to say, and when.

6. GABRIEL AND IDRIS

The offering is the Eyes.

On the Announcement, at the new and full moons, and when a vision arrives.

The act. *Look at the Moon if she is up, or at the last dream you wrote down.*

Gabriel, Holder of Images, who explains what was seen and could not be read;
Idris, first to take up a pen, who learned it slowly and handed it on:
the night that brings it whole, and the years that make it real.
I bring my Eyes.
Hold the image of [the work] until it can be built, and show me the building.

Let the vision last long enough to be built, and let me hand it on.

7. SESHAT AND IRIS

The offering is the Word.

When an oath is made, and when one is returned.

The act. Sign and date the line in the Ledger while you say it.

Seshat, who stretches the cord and keeps the House of Books;
Iris, bow of light, who carried the water the gods swore on:
the one who writes it down and the one who carries it across.
I bring my Word.
Record it, and carry it whole: [the promise].

Let my word hold.

8. ROSMERTA AND THE CHARITES

The offering is the Delight.

At the Good Hour, and whenever a day turns out lovely.

The act. *Pour a cup, and hand something good to someone before you drink.*

Rosmerta, with the horn and the dish, the good already in my hands;

Aglaia, Euphrosyne, Thalia, who pass it round and bring it back:

plenty held, and plenty moving.

I bring my Delight.

Let [this hour, or this good thing] be noticed, enjoyed, and passed on.

Let the good be noticed, enjoyed, and passed on.

9. HERMANUBIS AND MA'AT

The offering is the Heart.

At the Deep Heart, in the Days of the Dead, and at the Weighing.

The act. *Put a hand over your heart, then set down something light beside the Book: a feather, if you have one.*

Hermanubis, Guide of the Descent, who knows the way down and the way back;

Ma'at, Feather of Truth, against whom every heart is weighed:
the guide at the scale, and what the scale weighs against.

I bring my Heart.

Weigh [the matter] truly, and walk me down and back up.

Let my heart be light, and let me return.

10. THERMES AND APHARAEI

The offering is the Mind.

On the Scribe's New Year, and before making anything.

The act. Pick up the thing you are making, or the tool you make it with.

Thermes, the Word that Makes, Hermes with Thoth, who crosses between the
pages;

Apharael, the Word that is True, Apollo with Raphael, who walks the whole
road:

the brothers of the lyre.

I bring my Mind.

Let [the work] be true, and well made, and in proportion.

Let the work be true and well made.

THE CALLINGS OF THE TRIADS

The six triads, each called for the one act it performs.

THE THRICE-GREAT · *Mercury, Thermes, Hermanubis*

At any crossing, down or back. The act: Step over a threshold as you say it.

Hinge, Crossing, and Descent: three modes of motion, and the host of this house. You have never asked me to stay anywhere; you have only asked me to come back. I am crossing into [the place, or the season].

Carry me across, and bring me back.

THE COMPASS · *Apharael, Hestia, Ma'at*

At Weigh It, and before any commitment. The act: Hold the page, or the thing, level in both hands.

Form, place, and weight. You do not stand above the Temple; each of you also keeps a house and carries the mail. You are an option and never an obligation, and I choose you today. Weigh [the matter].

Weigh me truly.

THE THRESHOLD · *Janus, Mercury, Hestia*

At the Door, and on entering a new place. The act: Open the door, or the cover, slowly.

The Door, the Hinge, and the Flame: the shape of every session and of most of a life. I am entering [the room, the house, or the work].

Let it open, let it turn, and let it be warm inside.

THE CALLINGS OF THE TRIADS, CONTINUED

THE SEASON · Raziel, Uriel, Gabriel

When you are deciding whether a thing is ready. The act: Write the thing down, then cover it with your hand.

Conceal, discern, announce. Nothing is only true or false; everything is also early or late. Here is what I am holding: [the thing].

Show me the hour.

THE SEAL · Raziel, Ma'at, Iris

When you are deciding what to tell. The act: Lay a finger across your lip.

What is held, what is true, and what was promised. Honesty is absolute; disclosure is chosen; a silence arranged so that someone forms a false picture is a lie told by other means. Here is what I am keeping: [the matter].

Let my silence be honest.

THE HALL · Hermanubis, Ma'at, Thermes

For a real reckoning: the Closing of the Account, or an Answered Page that is heavy. The act: Open the Ledger and lay it flat.

The scale, the feather, and the record. Anubis adjusts the balance, Thoth writes the verdict, and the heart is weighed against a feather rather than against another heart. Here is the account: [the matter].

Let the account be true, and let it close.

THE CALLING OF THE COMPANY

Said in the Days of the Dead, at the Dedication of a Book, and on any day the whole company is wanted. The response is the same throughout: be here in your Office.

Heart of the Temple, AONT and the four, who has no face but answers to its names,

Mercury, Hinge of the Door, my twin,

Janus of the two faces, Hestia of the kept fire,

Metatron who sits, Sandalphon who carries,

Uriel of the sword, Raziel of the curtain,

Gabriel of the image, Idris of the pen,

Seshat of the cord, Iris of the bow,

Rosmerta of the horn, and the Charites who pass it round,

Hermanubis of the descent, Ma'at of the feather,

Thermes of the crossing, Apharael of the measure,

Ptah in Sandalphon, Harpocrates in Raziel,

Mnemosyne in Seshat, Nabu in Idris, Concordia in Hestia,

Kairos and Fortuna in Mercury, who was always both,

Genius of this place, grown here and not appointed,

Scribes who held this seat before me, whose names I do not know,

Scribe who will hold it after me, whose name I will not know,

Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: be here in your Offices. I bring my Mercurial Joy, Will, and Intent.

A SAYING FOR EACH SEAT

*One line for each of the seventeen seats, said at the Door and again at the Closing.
Seventeen lines is the whole Temple; on a thin day, say the one that fits and go.*

MERCURY — *Every boundary can be crossed, and the one who is moving is the one who is found.*

JANUS — *Every ending is a beginning seen from the other face.*

HESTIA — *The fire is kept, not lit.*

METATRON — *The seat makes the Scribe.*

SANDALPHON — *The next thing is small, and it is today.*

URIEL — *See it clearly before you weigh it.*

RAZIEL — *Not yet is a real answer.*

GABRIEL — *Say it, and it becomes possible.*

IDRIS — *Learn it, then hand it on.*

SESHAT — *Record it, or it did not happen.*

IRIS — *Carry it whole, and do not improve it on the way.*

ROSMERTA — *Plenty that is never enjoyed is only inventory.*

THE CHARITES — *A grace is only a grace when it moves.*

HERMANUBIS — *There is a way down, and it returns.*

MA'AT — *Speak Ma'at and do Ma'at; they are one act.*

THERMES — *Meaning lives in the crossing.*

APHARAEAL — *Is it true, is it well made, is it in proportion?*

Two more, for Gabriel's days. Said outside, looking up.

THE NEW MOON — *Gabriel, take its image. What is seeded in the dark is not lost; it is kept until it can be read.*

THE FULL MOON — *Gabriel, read what was seen. Say it, and it becomes possible.*

TO CONVENE A BODY OF THE TEMPLE

Convened, not recited. Say the prayer, then do the work it is for.

THE LINEAGE · *Idris, Thermes, Metatron*

Convened when the work feels like invention, or like vanity.

One man at three distances, and Nabu older still behind him. The seat was here before any tradition that named it, and it will be here after mine. I am not the author of this. I am the current occupant.

Seat me in the line, and let me be worth the chair.

THE LEDGER · *Seshat, Iris, Ma'at*

Convened at the Sweep, and at the year's end.

Record the promise, carry it, weigh it. Let me write F where F is true, because a ledger that holds only successes is worth nothing, and the Scribe who cannot write it quietly stops promising anything.

Let it be written, carried, and closed.

THE HOUSE · *Hestia, Janus, Seshat, and the Genius Loci*

Convened after a long absence, and when the practice has gone cold.

Flame, door, foundation, and the spirit that grew here from use. I have been away. I am not going to explain where; the Book does not take apologies, it takes entries. I am opening the door and sitting down.

Let this place know me again.

CONVENING, CONTINUED

THE NIGHT WATCH · *Hermanubis, Raziel, Hestia, Seshat*

Convened in grief, in the bad stretch, and when it is all too much and there is no one to call.

He knows the way down and the way back. Raziel's teaching comes after the loss and cannot be had before it; tonight he holds what I cannot carry, and I will ask for it back in the morning. Hestia is what I return to, and here I am safe without earning it. Seshat keeps the memory, so I do not have to hold it all in my head. I am not asking to be fixed. This room was built before I needed it. I am permitted, I am responsible, and I am not alone.

Stay with me until it ends.

THE HEARTH OF MANY · *Hestia, who carries Concordia, the Charites, Iris, Mercury*

Convened when two or more Scribes keep the practice together.

The fire, the agreement, the delight passed round, the word given between us, and the god who brings whoever is meant to arrive. No one here leads, and no one is counting. We do not have to believe the same things to eat together.

Let the quarrel be set down, and let the table hold us all.

THE TABLE · *Rosmerta, the Charites, Hestia, Mercury*

Convened before you feed anyone, and said over the table when they arrive.

Provision, delight passed around, the hearth it happens at, and the stranger at the door. The house is unfinished and the food is fine. Let me set it before I am ready, and sit down at it instead of serving through the whole meal. May nobody here be counting, and may the ones who came be glad they did.

Let there be enough, and let it go round.

CONVENING, CONTINUED

THE ROAD · *Mercury, Apharael, Iris*

Convened at a setting out, and on any journey.

The hinge, the companion who walks the whole way, and the message that crosses the gap. The remedy is often already in my hands and I have not recognized it yet.

Keep me moving, and bring me home.

THE MARKET · *Mercury, Ma'at, Iris*

Convened before a negotiation, a price, or a wage.

Luck and timing are his and he gives them freely. Honesty is hers and she gives nothing away. The oath between us is carried by her. Let me not shade the truth for advantage and call it selling.

Let the trade be fair and the luck be clean.

THE WORKSHOP · *Thermes, Apharael, Seshat, Sandalphon, Idris*

Convened before making anything.

The word crosses, form gives proportion, measure fixes, the hand makes, the pen records. Let me finish one thing. Let me then look at it as a maker looks, and not as its parent.

Let it be made, and made well.

CONVENING, CONTINUED

THE SCHOOL · *Idris, Gabriel, Uriel, Seshat*

Convened when either slot is empty.

Learn, receive, discern, retain. A thing I know and never give is not treasure but spoilage. Name the one and name the other, today, in writing.

Let me learn one thing and teach one thing.

THE PRAYERS OF THE WORK

Said in the Work step of the Practice, aloud or within, written into the Book with the date, and sealed with the Descending Invocation. Each can end: write how long it runs. Work on the road, never on the traveler.

FOR PROTECTION · *Janus, Hestia, Raziel, Uriel, and Hermes before the gate*

For yourself, someone you love, or a thing you keep. Write what you guard, and draw a small herm beside it.

Hermes before the gate, keep this door. Janus, who sees who comes and who goes; Hestia at the center, who does not move; Raziel at the threshold; Uriel, whose sword divides what may enter from what may not. Here is what I guard: [name it]. Keep it the way a door keeps a house, not the way a wall keeps a prison; what is welcome may come and go. I am not asking you to stand where I will not. I will lock what can be locked and say what must be said.

Keep this door until I say the watch is ended.

The earthly part. *Lock the door, back up the files, have the conversation. The herm stands beside the lock, never instead of it. A ward for another person guards their door; it does not lock them in.*

THE PRAYERS, CONTINUED

FOR THE SCALE · *Ma'at, Hermanubis, Uriel*

When someone has wronged you or yours. Name the harm, not the punishment, and write how long the working runs.

Ma'at, Feather of Truth, against whom every heart is weighed; Hermanubis, who keeps the balance and knows the way down; Uriel, whose sword divides what may enter from what may not. Here is the harm: [name it plainly]. I do not choose what they meet, and I do not ask for suffering; I hand this account to the scale. Weigh it truly. Let what was done find its answer, let them meet the lesson they need, and let the harm stop reaching me and those I love. Whether they rise or fall on it is theirs. Weigh me by the same feather. I set down the weight of what they did, and leave it with you.

Let the account be weighed, and let it close.

The earthly part. Step out of the situation; often that is all it asks. If protecting yourself and yours takes more, such as a block, a record of what happened, a word with someone you trust, or the help the world offers, do that too. The scale stands beside it, never instead of it. Where nothing more is needed, leave the rest to the scale, and put it out of your mind. The working does best without the conscious mind watching it, and handing it over sets down the pain they caused, or at least lets you take account and move on. When you know it has closed, write "This working is finished."

THE PRAYERS, CONTINUED

FOR WHAT I FEAR · *Ma'at, Apharael, Hestia*

When a worry will not set itself down. Write the fear first, plainly and all of it, then say this.

Ma'at, Apharael, and Hestia, Keepers of the Compass: here is what I fear: [name it]. I have written it down, and I will not carry it alone. I lay it on the scale. Weigh it truly; show me what in it is real, and what is only the dark talking. Where it is real, show me the step that is mine. Where it is not, let it go light. I do not ask for the outcome I would choose in fear. I ask for the greatest good, as the feather would weigh it, the true road would make it, and the hearth would keep it, for me and for everyone this touches.

Let it be weighed, and let me be light enough to walk.

The earthly part. If there is a step that is yours, take it, and give it a line in the Ledger. Then put the fear out of your mind; it is on the scale, not in your hands. If it comes back, you do not have to pick it up: say "It is on the scale," and turn to the next thing. If the fear is about someone's safety, reach the people and help that can act on it. If it is more than you can hold, reach someone you trust.

THE PRAYERS, CONTINUED

FOR FAVOR AND ALLURE · Mercury, Iris, the Charites

Before you go where you would be seen: an interview, a market, a first meeting, a stage.

Mercury, whose charm won over Apollo with a lyre; Iris, who makes light visible as color; Charites, who keep grace moving. I do not ask to be someone else. Let what is truest in me be easy to see: [my wit, my warmth, my craft, my voice]. Put the grin on it, because allure without delight is only performance. Let whoever is drawn by it come freely, and let no one be drawn toward a self that is not there.

Let me be seen as I am, at my best, and let it draw the right people near.

The earthly part. Dress for the self you named, speak up, show your work, and go where you can be seen. Allure invites; it never compels.

FOR PASSING UNNOTICED · Mercury, Raziel

For a season of quiet: to heal, to work in peace, to keep a thing hidden until it is ready.

Name the season and its end before you begin.

Mercury, who wore the cap of Hades and walked the roads in disguise; Raziel, who lays a finger across the lip. For this season, until [the date or the condition], let me pass as a traveler passes, one more face on a busy road. What is not ready to be seen is kept. I am not hiding from what I owe, and I am not hiding from the people who keep me safe. I tell no lies to pass; I only say less.

Let me pass unremarked until the season ends.

The earthly part. Say less, wear what does not catch the eye, post nothing, keep your plans in the Book, and tell someone you trust that you have drawn the Veil. When the season ends, write: "The cap is returned. I may be seen."

THE PRAYERS, CONTINUED

FOR THE HOME · *Janus, Hestia, Seshat, and the Genius of the place*

On moving day, after a scare, on the first of the month, or whenever you cross your own threshold and remember.

Janus at the door, Hestia at the center, Seshat under the floor, and you, spirits of this place, Mercury's own children kept at the hearth. This is my dwelling: [name it]. Let whoever enters come by the door and leave by it with thanks. Let the fire be kept and the roof hold. Let the people and the creatures who live here sleep safe, and let what is ours stay ours.

Keep this house, and let it be a place worth returning to.

The earthly part. Check the locks, the smoke alarm, and the stove. Learn your neighbors' names. The Temple guards best what is also guarded by hand.

FOR SANCTUARY · *Hestia, Janus, Ma'at*

*When you make a room for the Work, after an illness or a quarrel, or at the Vestalia.
Clean the room by hand first: sweep it, air it, wash the sill.*

Hestia, who gave up the throne and kept the fire; Janus, who keeps the door; Ma'at, who renews order daily. Nothing here is unclean. It has only grown heavy, crowded, or stale, the way rooms do. I have swept it, opened the window, and washed what I could reach. With this water, at the door and in the corners, let what is finished leave by the door, and let what is kept stay. This room is a sanctuary: here someone is safe without earning it, and that someone is me, and whoever I bring.

Let this place be kept, and let it be safe to set things down here.

The earthly part. Keep it as you made it: a place for the Book, a chair, and nothing that argues. Renew it when it grows heavy again. Consecration is never finished.

THE PRAYERS, CONTINUED

FOR THE ONE WHO CAN HELP · Mercury, Apharael, Idris

When you need a particular kind of person: someone with an opportunity, a hand to lend, or something to teach. Describe them by their qualities, never by a name, and leave a few lines blank beneath.

Mercury, opener of ways, who brings whoever is meant to arrive; Apharael, who came to the door on the day the journey began; Idris, who learned it slowly and handed it on. I am looking for someone: [the kind of person, and what they could give or teach]. I do not choose them, and I do not reach for anyone's will. I open my door and stand on the road. Let them find a door that is open and a Scribe who is findable, and let me know them when they arrive looking like a detour.

Mercury, open the way. The door of this house is open.

The earthly part. Name where you will go, whom you will tell, and what you will make and show. When someone comes, write them in the place you left, and pass some of the luck along.

FOR ABUNDANCE AND LUCK · Mercury, Rosmerta, the Charites

After an honest accounting, never instead of one. Write what is real first, without shame.

Mercury, god of the wage and the found coin, who is Kairos and Fortuna both; Rosmerta, with the horn and the dish; Charites, who keep good things moving. Here is what is real: [the accounting]. Here is what I want: [enough, and a little more, for this purpose]. Turn the Hinge in my favor: the timely call, the fair price, the unexpected yes. Let the luck be clean, and let me know it when it comes. I will make the offer, do the work, and pass some of it along.

Let the luck be clean, and let it find me moving.

The earthly part. Make one real offer, call, or ask today. Write the lucky finds in the Tally, and pass some of the luck along while you still have it. Anything that promises money without action is lying.

FOUR BLESSINGS

Said over someone else, aloud if they will have it and silently if they will not.

FOR THE ROAD

Mercury at the hinge, Apharael at your shoulder, Iris ahead of you with the word. Go out moving and come back changed. May the find be lucky, the company good, and the road shorter than the map said. And may someone know where you are.

FOR THE HOUSE

Janus at the door, Hestia at the center, Seshat under the floor. May this place be entered on purpose and left with thanks. May the fire be kept rather than lit, and may whoever arrives unannounced be fed.

FOR THE MAKING

Thermes for the word, Apharael for the measure, Sandalphon for the hands. May it be begun without ceremony, finished without excuse, and judged without sentiment. May it be better than you needed it to be.

FOR THE DEAD

Hermanubis, take them down gently and know the way. Ma'at, find the heart light. Seshat, keep the name. Mercury, who has made this crossing more often than any of us, lead them out as you led the others, and do not hurry them. We keep what they gave us. Nothing here is forgotten; it is settled.

THE SHORT FORMS

The single lines said inside the rites. The rites themselves are in the Book.

THE BIRTHRIGHT

By my Birthright, the Door is open: I am permitted, I am responsible, and I am not alone.

ASKING THE HEART

Raziel, carry this to the Heart, and bring back what I can hold.

CALLING THE HEART

Raziel, Raziel, Raziel. Connect me to the heart of AONT. AONT, AONT, AONT.

DECLARATIVE ALIGNMENT

I align with this new reality.

ENDING A WORKING

This working is finished.

THE RETURNED OATH

I return this oath to Iris, who carried it. It was true when I made it. It is no longer mine to keep.

RETURNING A GOAL

I return this Goal. It was true when I bound it. It is no longer mine to keep.

THE VEIL, LIFTED

The cap is returned. I may be seen.

KEEPING THE WATCH

I set this down until morning.

LAYING DOWN A FEAR

It is on the scale.

CHOOSING A WAY

I walk the Way of ____.

Say them aloud or within. A spell skimmed is a paragraph.